

# KF35 Meeting Version of Teachings

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Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

**0:01    OPENING**

**0:02    PRESENTING**

**0:06    KARIS CIRCULATION**

**0:07    GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS**

**0:08    MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING**

## **Lectio Divina**

Assume your meditation posture and breathe. Straighten your neck as you lower your chin a little. Allow your shoulders to relax and fall back. *(Pause)* You might use the word *CALM* to center yourself. Take the next minute to scan your body for tension and then release it on the exhale. Breathe. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

### **1. Read the passage**

I will read a short sentence from the Bible and then pause. Our text is John 17:17 in which Jesus prays for His people.

*Set them apart into the truth.  
(Repeat) (Pause for 10 seconds)*

### **2. Receive as you listen**

Relax while I read this sentence three times, pausing between readings. On the last reading I will use the first-person pronoun. Take the attitude of a listener and gently observe your experience with the words. Let's begin. *(Use the singular pronoun for the last reading)*

*Set them (me) apart into the truth.  
(Read 3 times, pausing for 30 seconds after each reading)*

### **3. Respond**

Respond to God with affirmation and gratitude. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

### **4. Rest in awareness**

Rest in stillness for one minute as you contemplate what you have experienced during this time. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Pause and re-engage with your environment. You may wish to take this next minute to record your

experience in your KF journal or on your **Meeting Preparation Guide**, or you might wish to simply wait.  
(Pause for 1 minute)

Pause. You can practice the **Lectio Divina** by reading the entire chapter of John 17 and then focusing on a phrase or verse that strikes you, or you might meditate on any other passage or story from the Bible. Take a little time to explore the Scripture through repetition and listening. Breathe, and let God reorient your spirit with the truth of the words.

Our hymn for KF Confession 8 is *And Can It Be?*

Long my imprisoned spirit lay,  
Fast-bound in sin and nature's night.  
Thine eye diffused a quickening ray—  
I woke, the dungeon flamed with light!  
My chains fell off, my heart was free;  
I rose, went forth, and followed Thee.  
My chains fell off, my heart was free;  
I rose, went forth, and followed Thee.<sup>1</sup>

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about this training?”)

## **0:20 KARIS CONFESSION**

## **0:21 TOOLBOX**

KF Confession 8 reminds us of our real business:

We co-labor with the Creator to seek and to save that which was lost.

This month we’ve been talking about our CORE strength—courage, orientation, reality, and endurance. Strong CORE muscles are necessary for tackling the challenges that lie ahead as we seek and save what has been lost. We have already looked at courage and orientation. Courage is feeling the fear and yet choosing orientation anyway. Orientation is a state of flow and harmony with God and the Creation, and we enter into this dynamic state through something called obedience. Obedience demonstrates our choice to live in the reality of our design. As God’s creatures, we are designed to enjoy a fulfilling relationship with our Creator, and we can only flourish when that relationship is our goal.

Let’s explore this idea of reality.

### **1. What is reality?**

Reality is what you have to deal with today. It includes your personal strengths, weaknesses, and antecedents—and those of others. It also includes the prescribed limitations and enforced order of civil law and your community culture. Another reality that cannot be avoided is the universal law of cause and effect.

If we are to dwell in love, our commitment to reality is essential. If we prefer illusions, we cannot love no matter what our imagination tells us.

## 2. Who are you, really?

God created you to be an eternally unfolding discovery to yourself, to others, and to Him. When you are busy judging yourself, hating yourself, or controlling and suppressing yourself, it's difficult to explore yourself. You will make up all sorts of stories about why you should not use time and resources for exploration and self-discovery. These stories seem credible because in the past you have successfully used them to maintain your pride system. Your stories and excuses are often driven by fear—fear of yourself, fear of what others will think or do, and fear of what you might lose.

## 3. It is real that you are a human creature

Every human being is a creature, and since you are human, you are also a creature. Like every other creature, you are finite and impermanent in this material world and subject to the limitations of an animal. You must work, and you must rest. You must make mistakes, and just like any puppy or lion cub, you must be trained to reach your potential. You are not a god. You are a creature with limitations. This is a reality.

## 4. You are subject to the limitations of the Creation

There are physical laws, and there are energetic laws. There are civil, social, and financial laws—and there are spiritual laws for healing and growth. These laws apply to everyone, and they function on the principle of cause and effect. So, if you want to achieve a particular outcome, you will have to live within the limitations of cause and effect. For example, if you want to develop trusting relationships, you must become the cause by becoming trustworthy yourself. If you want to heal your soul, you must become the cause by creating the kind of life that allows you the time and resources to heal.

## 5. How do you invest in your True Self?

If you want to invest in your True Self, you must learn to live within the limitations of God's design and His rules for physical, mental, and spiritual health. KF training teaches you how to do that. The practice of mindfulness helps you observe and explore your present reality; you learn to recognize your shoulds, your claims, and your pride system, as well as your preferences and delights. You also have your KF toolbox. You can reach in and choose a tool to help you unload the extra baggage of idolatry that cripples your courage and your ability to endure.

There are a number of non-KF tools that have also helped KF members glimpse the pearl of their True Self.<sup>2</sup> One of these tools is the *Myers-Briggs Type Indicator* assessment, which helps you recognize the characteristics associated with your personality type.<sup>3</sup> There are several books available that offer and explain the assessment, and you can go online to find descriptions of the different types. These descriptions may help you recognize aspects of your True Self.

Another tool that some KF members have found helpful often triggers fear and judgment in Christians. This particular tool is a combination of science and art and is as old as the human experience with God. Perhaps you can just observe this suggestion without taking the Judgment Path.

We know that God created cycles and seasons in the material world and, also, in our lives. In Genesis 1:14–20, we learn that God designed these cycles and seasons to be governed, or directed, by the sun, the moon, and the stars. We also learn from Psalm 19 that the heavens declare the glory of God. Some Christians believe that it benefits us and God's purposes if we understand what the lights in the heavens reveal about our unique design and its potential. One blog post that you may find interesting is *Astrology from a Christian Perspective*.<sup>4</sup>

There is no need to feel fear right now. Nancy's aim is to give you whatever help she can. She is simply offering a tool that has helped many Christians get a clearer picture of their True Self.

Finally, feedback from others can give you a glimpse of your True Self. If you can be trusted to respond with gratitude and moderation, others can safely reflect back to you areas of your life that need orienting. Their observations are so valuable. Members of a trustworthy community can also help you recognize your natural strengths and unique abilities. They can encourage you to have mercy on your True Self when it shines in all of its underdevelopment and lack of skill.

This week, you might pray this prayer:

*Designer of my soul, I want to know my True Self. Show me how to bring it to the light. (Repeat)*

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?")*

### **0:30    SHARING**

### **1:00    BIBLE TEACHING**

Let's turn to **Philippians 4:4–9** and read these verses together in Nancy's translation.

<sup>4</sup>Take your pleasure in the Lord at all times. I will say it again, take pleasure in Him. <sup>5</sup>Let your oriented and capable abilities be known to everyone. Let others know that through you the Lord is near. <sup>6</sup>Treat nothing with anxious care, but in everything by prayer and entreaty, mixed with thankfulness, let God know what you want, <sup>7</sup>and the peace of God in Christ Jesus, which exceeds and has a wider extension than all of your limited reasoning, will keep watch over your motivations and perceptions. <sup>8</sup>And beyond that, siblings, in all your dealings take into account what is true, what is divinely noble, what is oriented and just, what is undefiled and pure, what is beloved, what imparts good omen. Notice if anything is excellent and commendable. <sup>9</sup>And make it your business to practice the things that you have learned and taken to yourself, as well as what you have heard and seen in me, and the God of peace will be with you.

Take a deep breath.

Who wants reality? Sometimes reality feels like a grim existence, full of hard slogging, frustrations, and anxiety. These perceptions come from the Idol Self. Like an expert in war propaganda, the Idol uses false reasonings to convince us that reality is our enemy and illusion is our friend. The True Self thrives in reality, so if the Idol can convince us to hate and resist reality, we are only one small step away from hating and resisting the True Self.

God, however, only works in reality. He works with the truth of who we are and the truth about our development. He wants reality to become our natural habitat. If we choose to live in reality rather than illusion and courageously grapple with the challenges, limitations, and possibilities of real life, God can confidently trust us with all the marvelous experiences, fun, and delights that He has in mind.

Here are a few points that Nancy would like you to consider from this passage.

**1. Take your pleasures with the Lord in mind**

The quality of your work toward orientation is often revealed in how you use pleasure. The Idol Self uses pleasure to escape reality and to escape the real God. The True Self experiences pleasure while enjoying God, His creation, and His gifts. As your True Self grows, so does your capacity to enjoy. God is longing to share with you His delights, but if you use your capacity for pleasure to medicate, escape, or stagnate, He cannot trust you with these gifts.

**2. Prayer is real**

God listens to oriented people who are guarding the commandments of Jesus in their lives.

**3. God's peace is real**

Real peace is not found in the stories and logic that we use to relieve our anxiety and restore our pride. Unshakable peace is the fruit of trusting in God's desire and ability to be active in our lives as we choose to live in reality and cooperate with Him. We are not alone in our efforts to grow. God is a real player in our lives, and He provides skilled people in the community who can help us learn to live in reality.

**4. Our choices are real**

Through Jesus, God has shown us what human glory looks like. However, we are not conformed to this glorious image by magic or without effort on our part. We have to make choices that lead us toward that goal. There are things we must choose to take on, and there are things we must choose to give up.

**5. Our spiritual nature is real**

Reality also includes the marvelous things that stream from the unseen—those flashes of understanding that are like beacons guiding us home. Mindfulness training helps us catch these moments of inspiration that remind us of who we are and where we are really going. In all our dealings, mindfulness training helps us stay focused on realities that are divinely noble, oriented and just, undefiled and pure, excellent and commendable, beloved, and imparting good omen. Maintaining this focus trains our material existence to cooperate with and express the reality of our spiritual nature.

This is Nancy's translation of First Peter 2:9. In this verse, the apostle describes the real mission of our redeemed True Self and our true identity as the children of God.

You are a select generation, a sovereign priesthood, a company set apart, a people kept safe so that you may proclaim the wonders and goodness of Him who invited you to come out of the darkness and enter into His marvelous light.

Take a deep breath.

Let's continue training so that we might become the glorious people God designed us to be.

Our prayer might go something like this:

*God and Savior, I want to proclaim Your wonders and Your goodness through my life. (Repeat)*

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?”)*

## **1:10 INTEGRATION**

Sip some purified water and prepare to take some notes. Assume your meditation posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider a situation in which you might choose reality. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

### **The FAITH Process**

#### **Feelings**

As you *consider a situation in which you might choose reality*, how does it feel? *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. You can learn to recognize and honor your feelings without allowing them to master you. *(Pause)* Recognize with compassion whatever you are experiencing, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

#### **Awareness without judgment**

Allow your experience to rest in your awareness. You might notice a compulsion to push away the positive evidence, perhaps the evidence of how well you are actually doing or how positive a situation really is. Perhaps you push away positive evidence because a situation doesn't meet your standards. You might find yourself pushing away what you do not wish to recognize or are afraid to acknowledge. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

#### **Inquiry: What is my body saying?**

Bring your attention to your body and notice how it signals you when you *consider this situation in which you might choose reality*. Gently focus your attention on those signals. *(Pause)* If your sensations are uncomfortable, you can move your attention to an area of your body that is not reacting, and rest. When you are ready, return to respectfully observe those uncomfortable sensations, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

#### **Talk to Jesus**

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider choosing reality*. Is your experience right now pleasant, unpleasant, or vague and slippery? Just observe. *(Pause)* Are you afraid of seeing the real, positive evidence of change in yourself or in others? Are you resisting what the truth is teaching you? Observe your responses as just information, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

#### **Heal**

As you breathe, repeat the word *Welcome*. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

*(Pause for 8 seconds or one long breath after each statement)*

- Welcome this opportunity to explore what is real.
- Welcome the Holy Spirit of truth and His desire to liberate you through the truth.
- Welcome your present reality and the progress you and others have made.
- Welcome what you are learning about yourself. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Now, as you breathe, you might use the following statements as a confession to the Lord and turn away from the Idol Self. On the exhale, let go.<sup>5</sup>

*(Pause for 5 seconds after each statement)*

- As I learn to mindfully rejoice in reality, I let go of the craving for power and control.
- As I learn to mindfully rejoice in reality, I let go of the craving for admiration and affection.
- As I learn to mindfully rejoice in reality, I let go of the craving for security and comfort.
- As I learn to mindfully rejoice in reality, I let go of the craving for perfection. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

*(Optional)* Continue to breathe while I test for further integration.

Pause. Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")*

## **1:28 ENDING PRAYER**

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for drawing us together for our healing and training. Hold us in the power of the truth of who we actually are and what we have been created to do. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?")*

## **1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS**

\*Registration is open for next year's NHG book study. All KF members are welcome to attend and are also invited to sign up on the website to facilitate one or more of the sessions.

*(\*Except when preparing for the Jubilee Year)*

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<sup>1</sup> *And Can It Be?* by Charles Wesley (1707–1788); [www.youtube.com/watch?v=sQelGbKqiw8](http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sQelGbKqiw8).

<sup>2</sup> Matt. 13:45–46.

<sup>3</sup> [www.humanmetrics.com/cgi-win/jtypes2.asp](http://www.humanmetrics.com/cgi-win/jtypes2.asp).

<sup>4</sup> [www.thoughtco.com/astrology-from-a-christians-perspective-207246](http://www.thoughtco.com/astrology-from-a-christians-perspective-207246).

<sup>5</sup> [www.camillecaldwell.com/WelcomePrayer.html](http://www.camillecaldwell.com/WelcomePrayer.html). Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.